

Getting Crusoe's connectivity buyer on the line

Account entry plan for Spencer Refer | Prepared Thursday, October 1, 2026 | Sources: HubSpot, Lemlist, ZoomInfo, Apollo

\$3.9B Series F, Sep 17, 2026 (\$30.9B valuation)	11 Crusoe leads in Wave C, 0 replies	1 person whose job is buying connectivity	0 times that person has been contacted
STAGE Wave C prospect. No deal.	RUNNING NOW CTF ABM - Crusoe (Wave C), 11 leads; plus older 'CTF ABM - Crusoe' list	LAST TOUCH Sep 29: VM to Ramesh Nampelly; live call with Srinivasa Birudaraju (left Crusoe)	NEXT STEP Mon Oct 5: email Matthew Mahon (Category Manager, Connectivity)

Bottom line

Crusoe has more money to build AI factories than almost anyone: a **\$3.9B Series F on Sep 17**, a reported \$13B Jane Street contract, a new Texas campus (Sep 28) and partnerships with Perplexity and Thinking Machines. Your Wave C sequence has eleven people, from VPs to a housing director, and nobody has replied. The one live conversation (Sep 29) was with Srinivasa Birudaraju, who has **left Crusoe** and said Crusoe wasn't looking at Chicago fiber when he left. The person you haven't contacted is the one who buys circuits: **Matthew Mahon, Category Manager, Connectivity** (joined Jun 2026, ex-AWS edge planner, ex-eBay connectivity sourcing). The plan narrows the account to Mahon and the network-operations manager, Andrei Dumitrescu, and asks one question: does Crusoe's Illinois footprint need diverse metro paths?

What Crusoe is, in one analogy

Crusoe builds power plants that make intelligence instead of electricity. Like any plant, it needs transmission lines to deliver its output. Engineers design the plant; a sourcing manager buys the lines. Your job is to get on the sourcing manager's shortlist.

Signals worth citing

Signal	Source	So what for the opener
\$3.9B Series F at \$30.9B valuation (Sep 17); reported \$3B round tied to a \$13B Jane Street contract (Sep 4)	ZoomInfo news	Capital to build. Jane Street is a Chicago-heavy trading firm, so low-latency trading workloads may matter.
New data center campus in Armstrong County, TX (Sep 28); second Tulsa factory (Sep 14)	ZoomInfo news	Building outside Chicago. Ask what's planned for the Midwest, not assume.
Matthew Mahon, Category Manager, Connectivity (Jun 2026). Ex-AWS Sr. Edge Planner, ex-eBay connectivity sourcing	Apollo	He buys circuits for a living and is new to the role, so his vendor list is still forming.
Kostas Kassaras (Head of Global Network Infrastructure) email bounced Sep 28	Lemlist	The most senior network leader has no working email on file. Fix before any next step.
Srinivasa Birudaraju (former Manager, Network Engineering) on Sep 29: no longer at Crusoe; when he left, Crusoe wasn't looking at Chicago fiber	HubSpot call log	Honest 'not now' from an insider. Treat Chicago as an open question, not an active need.

Check first

Crusoe has two Lemlist campaigns: 'CTF ABM - Crusoe (Wave C)' and an older 'CTF ABM - Crusoe' list that now holds contacts from other AI accounts (Cirrascale, Fluidstack, TensorWave, Lightning). Rename or close the older list so reports don't show Crusoe activity that's really about other companies.

Work already in motion

When	Channel / campaign	What happened	Read
Sep 11	Wave C, email 1	'Fiber just became the bottleneck, not the GPUs' to 8 leads; one inactive-account bounce	No replies
Sep 15-16	Wave C	LinkedIn steps skipped (no URLs); email steps skipped for bounced addresses	Sequence degraded
Sep 18-24	Wave C, email 2	'The part of your interconnect map you can't see'	No replies

When	Channel / campaign	What happened	Read
Sep 28	Wave C, email 3 + new lead	'Who owns this call at Crusoe Cloud?' to Nampelly; Kassaras added and bounced	-
Sep 29	Phone	Connected with Srinivasa Birudaraju: left Crusoe; Crusoe not interested in Chicago fiber when he left. VM to Ramesh Nampelly about Crusoe's Illinois PoPs.	First live intel
Sep 29	Wave C, new leads	Zaur Naghiyev and Raghunath Nagepalli (network/DC deployment) added	Not yet contacted

Who to reach, in order

Contact	Title (source)	Where	Why they matter	Status / email
Matthew Mahon	Category Manager, Connectivity (Apollo). Ex-AWS edge planner, ex-eBay connectivity sourcing.	New York	Literally buys connectivity. New in seat.	Not contacted. mmahon@crusoe.ai (verified)
Andrei Dumitrescu	Engineering Manager, Network Operations - AI Infrastructure (Apollo). Ex-Meta edge & peering.	n/a	Runs network ops; knows where paths are thin.	Not contacted. adumitrescu@crusoe.ai (verified)
Zaur Naghiyev	Sr. Network Engineer, Large-Scale DC & Global Backbone (HubSpot)	n/a	Backbone design; technical validator.	Added Sep 29; no touches yet
Ramesh Nampelly	VP, Head of Cloud Availability & Platform Engineering (HubSpot)	n/a	Availability owner; got 3 emails and a VM.	Wave C, no reply
Kostas Kassaras	Head of Global Network Infrastructure (HubSpot)	n/a	Most senior network leader.	Email bounced Sep 28; needs a valid address

Not worth chasing for this goal

Nathan Ashker (workforce housing), Andrew Likens (energy development), Omer Landau (VP Engineering, Israel), Bryan Schramm (edge product) and David Richardson are not connectivity buyers; let the sequence end for them. Srinivasa Birudaraju has left; mark him as a former employee in HubSpot.

How the access path should run



Messages, by contact

1. Matthew Mahon Category Manager, Connectivity

Why them: The buyer, new in role, untouched.

Channel: Email Mon Oct 5; LinkedIn connect without a note | Subject: Adding a Chicago metro option to your connectivity bench

Matthew, congrats on the move from AWS to Crusoe. I own underground dark fiber in Chicago, on-net at 350 E Cermak and Elk Grove. If Crusoe ever needs diverse metro paths in Illinois, I'd like to be a known option on your list before there's an RFP. Worth a 15-minute intro?

2. Andrei Dumitrescu Engineering Manager, Network Operations

Why them: Ops view: where outages come from.

Channel: Email Wed Oct 7 | Subject: Where Crusoe's Illinois paths are thin

Andrei, from your Meta edge and peering days you'll know most 'diverse' metro paths share a duct somewhere. If Crusoe has traffic in or through Chicago, I can send a map of our conduit so your team can check for overlap. Want it?

The plan

When	Move	Notes
Thu Oct 1	Mark Birudaraju as former employee; flag Kassaras email as invalid.	Data hygiene.
Fri Oct 2	Let Wave C finish for the senior VPs; no new steps.	-
Mon Oct 5	Email Matthew Mahon; add to HubSpot.	-
Wed Oct 7	Email Andrei Dumitrescu.	-
Mon Oct 12	Find a valid email for Kassaras (ZoomInfo).	Credits approved.
Week of Oct 19	Follow up with Mahon offering the Chicago KMZ.	-
Week of Oct 26	Goal: intro call with Mahon to get on Crusoe's connectivity vendor list.	-

What progress looks like (for management)

By	Milestone	How we will know
Oct 16	Reply from Mahon or Dumitrescu	Email logged
Oct 30	Crosstown on Crusoe's connectivity vendor list	Note from Mahon call

Guardrails

- Don't claim Crusoe has Chicago sites; ask.
- Credits used: 3 Apollo person enrichments; ZoomInfo company and signals for 1 company.

Sources

HubSpot contacts, call log (Sep 29) and meeting note; Lemlist 'CTF ABM - Crusoe (Wave C)' activity; ZoomInfo news (Sep 4-28, 2026; Jul 21, 30) and scoops; Apollo people data (Oct 1, 2026).